

investors employ the strategies that I believe made Warren Buffett successful.

Still there are skeptics. The major pushback we have received over the years is that reading a book about Warren Buffett will not ensure that you will be able to generate the same investment returns that Buffett achieved. First, I never insinuated that by reading the book an individual could achieve the same investment returns as Buffett. Second, I was puzzled why anyone would think so. It seemed to me that if you bought a book about how to play golf like Tiger Woods, you shouldn't expect to become Tiger's equal on the golf course. You read the book because you believe there are some tips in the book that will help improve your game. The same is true of *The Warren Buffett Way*. If, by reading this book, you pick up some lessons that help improve your investment results, then the book is a success. Considering how poorly most people perform in the stock market, achieving some improvement will not be a herculean task.

Buffett and Charlie Munger, the vice chairman of Berkshire and Buffett's intellectual sparring partner, were once asked about the possibility that their two great minds would educate a new generation of investors. That, of course, is exactly what they have been doing for the past 40 years. Berkshire Hathaway's annual reports are famous for their clarity, absence of mumbo jumbo, and superb educational value. Anyone fortunate enough to attend a Berkshire Hathaway annual meeting knows how illuminating they can be.

Gaining knowledge is a journey. On his own journey, Warren Buffett took much of the wisdom of others, starting with Benjamin Graham and Phil Fisher. To that, he would add the many business lessons he learned from his partner, Charlie Munger. Collectively these experiences have helped shape a mosaic of investment understanding that Buffett, in turn, generously shares with others—that is, to others who are willing to do their own homework and learn all they can, with a fresh, vigorous, open mind.

At the 1995 Berkshire Hathaway annual meeting, Charlie Munger said, "It's extraordinary how resistant some people are to learning anything." Buffett added, "What's really astounding is how resistant they are even when it's in their self-interest to learn." Then, in a more reflective tone, Buffett continued, "There is an incredible resistance to thinking or